Interface Mismatch Between the Redesigned Popup and the Watchlist Storage Module

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Abstract - The redesigned SpoilFree popup called watchlist methods and read item fields that the deployed storage module did not provide. This report describes how the mismatch arose, how it was found when the project files were supplied and the extension of the storage module that resolved it.

Index Terms, interface mismatch, chrome.storage, watchlist, refactoring, Chrome extension.

I. Introduction

The popup and the content script share state through local extension storage [1]. The watchlist module wraps that storage and is the only code that should know the item layout. The popup was rewritten from the conversation history, which did not contain the module source, so its calls were based on assumed names.

II. Problem Description

The rewritten popup called setProgress, setDone, a patch helper and addSeries with a second argument for match terms. The deployed module exposed init, getWatchlist, addSeries with a single name argument, removeSeries, toggleActive, getActiveSeries and two TVmaze accessors [2]. Items stored only an id, a title, a TVmaze id, an active flag and a timestamp. Progress, a finished flag and a movie flag did not exist, so progress and Finished controls would have failed at run time.

III. Implemented Solution

The module was extended instead of the popup working around it. Each new item stores a progress object with season and episode, a finished flag and a movie flag. Three methods were added: setProgress, setDone and a generic field patch. getActiveSeries now returns, for each active and unfinished title, its id, title, TVmaze id, match terms, progress and movie flag. The popup was changed to use removeSeries and to call addSeries with the name only, because the module already fetches TVmaze data itself and a second fetch was redundant.

IV. Verification

Both files passed a Node syntax check. The popup was rendered in a headless browser with stubbed storage and a stubbed module to confirm that rows, progress fields and the counter display correctly. Behaviour against real Chrome storage was not reproduced in the authoring environment.

V. Conclusion

Reading the real module source exposed the mismatch before release. Interfaces shared by the popup and the content script should be agreed once and tested against the actual files.

References

[1] Google, “chrome.storage,” Chrome for Developers. Accessed: Oct. 28, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://developer.chrome.com/docs/extensions/reference/api/storage

[2] TVmaze, “TVmaze API.” Accessed: Oct. 28, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.tvmaze.com/api